SWIM

Week 07 Swim

Week 7 of 52 | Mon 16 Nov 2026 to Sun 22 Nov 2026 | Month 2: Adaptation easing: a little more time at the top of Zone 2

The idea this month: short fast lengths with full rest, stroke count as the honesty check, fins as a teaching tool. Endurance volume comes back once the fast stroke is the default. 25 m pool. Every swim is 700-1,100 m and 22-35 minutes.

Monday, 16 Nov Swim 1 - Fast 50s (32 min)

Focus: First fast 50s. Twice the distance per rep, so the stroke count tells you more.

Section	Details
Warm-up	100 kick with fins (board, or on your back), then 100 easy FS. Fins are fine for every kick this month; bare-foot kick is not a speed set for anyone.
Drills	4 x 50 (25 Fist drill / 25 FS) r20
Main	6 x 50 fast r40. Fins on 1, 3 and 5. Hold the stroke count across both lengths; the second 25 is where it usually climbs.
Easy	4 x 50 FS r20
Cool-down	100 easy, any stroke, finish with the shoulder loose, not worked.

Total: about 1000 m

Notes: Fast means the quickest stroke you can hold at 12-13 strokes per 25 m (your count on 30 Oct). If the count climbs to 15-16 you are muscling it: take the full rest and swim the next one smoother, not harder. Rest is part of the set, never shorten it. Shoulder gate: the fast set happens only if the morning after the last swim was 0-1/10 (0 = no pain). At 2-3, swim the same distance easy instead. Sharp pain above 3 during a swim: kick and drills only, stop pulling. Fins yes, paddles no.

Thursday, 19 Nov Swim 2 - Fast 25s in rounds (30 min)

Focus: Short rest inside the round, a long easy 50 between rounds.

Section	Details
Warm-up	100 kick with fins (board, or on your back), then 100 easy FS. Fins are fine for every kick this month; bare-foot kick is not a speed set for anyone.
Drills	4 x 50 (25 Fingertip drag / 25 FS) r20
Main	3 rounds of (4 x 25 fast r20, then 50 easy). Rounds 1-2 without fins, round 3 with fins so the last fast lengths of the day are the quickest.
Cool-down	100 easy, any stroke, finish with the shoulder loose, not worked.

Total: about 950 m

Notes: Fast means the quickest stroke you can hold at 12-13 strokes per 25 m (your count on 30 Oct). If the count climbs to 15-16 you are muscling it: take the full rest and swim the next one smoother, not harder. Rest is part of the set, never shorten it. Shoulder gate: the fast set happens only if the morning after the last swim was 0-1/10 (0 = no pain). At 2-3, swim the same distance easy instead. Sharp pain above 3 during a swim: kick and drills only, stop pulling. Fins yes, paddles no. No pool today? 30-40 min elliptical at a conversational effort is the fallback, not a replacement to prefer.

Drill cue cards for this week

Drill	How to do it and what it trains
Fist drill	Swim freestyle with closed fists. You will feel the forearm doing the work. After 25 m of fists open the hands and notice the extra grip. Purpose: early vertical forearm and feel for the water.

Drill	How to do it and what it trains
Stroke count	Count strokes per 25 m (one arm = one stroke). Write down your normal count, then try to hold pace with one fewer. Purpose: efficiency and distance per stroke.
Fingertip drag	Swim normally but during the recovery let the fingertips trail along the surface, elbow high and pointing to the ceiling. Purpose: relaxed, high-elbow recovery and shoulder rotation.

Shoulder and stroke log (0 = no pain, 10 = worst pain)

Session	Shoulder during	Next morning	Strokes per 25, fast	Best 25 or 50 time	Notes
Monday					
Thursday					